

Tomasz Blackwater

Character Dossier

Quietly ambitious tax collector of Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987

Overview

Tomasz Blackwater is a tax collector living in Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987. Tomasz is 19 years old, originally from Fennick, and is known around the Falls Diner as quietly ambitious. In conversation Tomasz compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Background

Tomasz arrived in Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987 10 years ago after leaving Fennick under circumstances Tomasz describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Lumen Falls town council; the second was the one that stuck. Today Tomasz works as a tax collector near Route 12 gas station and is paid, when paid at all, in dollars.

Tomasz learned the trade from Thaddeus Grimsby, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Tomasz's life is with Gideon Fairweather, over a matter neither will explain. The person Tomasz trusts most is Isadora Okonkwo.

Current goal: to earn the title of master before turning fifty. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: quietly ambitious.

Speech pattern: Tomasz compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Tells: when lying, Tomasz mentions Marzipan the ferret for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Tomasz Blackwater
Role	tax collector
Home	Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987
Hometown	Fennick
Age	19
Favourite dish	festival miso eggplant
Pet	Marzipan, a ferret
Lucky number	878

<i>Workshop password</i>	indigo-umber
<i>Mentor</i>	Thaddeus Grimsby
<i>Rival</i>	Gideon Fairweather
<i>Closest friend</i>	Isadora Okonkwo

Secret

Tomasz owes Gideon Fairweather a debt of 292 dollars that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Tomasz: I am the tax collector. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Tomasz: Festival miso eggplant. Do not tell Gideon I said so.

Visitor: Is Marzipan yours?

Tomasz: Marzipan belongs to nobody. Marzipan tolerates me. Lucky number is 878, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 40

Octavia came by asking about the comet. Tomasz said nothing useful and made tea instead. Tomasz was hired to carry a tin whistle from the community radio shack to the shuttered paper mill without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Tomasz spent the day counting stock at the community radio shack: 51 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short.

Entry 2, winter of year 40

Tomasz repaired the clockwork bird at Pinecrest High for Katarina, who paid in 82 dollars and a long story about the tax on doors. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Tomasz and a neighbour outside Pinecrest High; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Tomasz won 11 dollars on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper. Tomasz was hired to carry a ledger from Pinecrest High to Route 12 gas station without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 3, autumn of year 40

The weather turned. Tomasz moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the old tunnels. Tomasz won 74 dollars on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Tomasz has a suspect and is probably right. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before.